the individual rights. The rights of the citizens of Great Britain flow from judicial decisions, not from the Constitution.

7. Constitutional Monarchy Great Britain is a monarchical state. It is described as a limited hereditary monarchy. The hereditary monarch (King or Queen) is the head of the state. The Crown is the visible symbol of the supreme executive power. However, the King or Queen only reigns, but does not rule. These powers are actually execised by the Cabinet headed by the Prime Minister. The Cabinet is collectively responsible to the Parliament for its actions and ultimately to the electorate. Hence, what Great Britain has is a 'constitutional monarchy'.

The distinction between the Crown and the King is the distinction between the monarchy as an institution and the monarch as a person. In other words, the King is a person whereas the Crown is an institution (i.e. the institution of kingship). The King is mortal whereas the Crown is immortal. This is clearly expressed by the popular statement in Great Britain that 'the King is dead; long live the King'. It means that the person who occupied the throne is dead but the institution of kingship survives.

8. Bicameralism The British Parliament is bicameral, that is, it consists of two houses, namely the House of Lords and the House of Commons.

The House of Lords is the upper House. It is the oldest second chamber in the world. It consist of lords, peers and nobles and hence, represent the aristocratic element of the British political system. At present it has 677 appointed members who fall into four distinct groups. It is mostly a hereditary body.

The House of Commons is the lower House but more important and powerful than the House of Lords. It is the oldest popular legislative body in the world. It consists of the representatives elected by the people on the basis of universal adult franchise. There are at present 659 seats in the House of Commons and these are distributed among England, Wales, Scotland and Northern Ireland.

British Cabinet

Composition As the British Constitution provides for parliamentary system of government, the Cabinet acts as the real executive authority. It consists of the Prime Minister as its head and twenty or so of his/her most senior ministerial colleagues. It includes the following:

1. Prime Minister and First Lord of the Treasury and Minister for the Civil Service
2. Chancellor of the Exchequer
3. Lord Privy Seal
4. Chancellor of the Duchy of Lancaster
5. Lord President of the Council
6. President of the Board of Trade
7. Lord Chancellor
8. First Lord of Admiralty
9. Post Master General